



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Oak Hill Academy
School Website: <https://oakhillacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Oak Hill Academy (Dallas, TX 75220) presents a mixed profile in relation to classical education. It demonstrates several formation-oriented and student-centered elements (e.g., a whole-child approach, small student-teacher ratios, emphasis on social-emotional growth, and a tiered curriculum) that align with classic aims of education as formation and virtue. However, explicit classical markers—such as sustained attention to Great Books, a grammar–logic–rhetoric trinity, deliberate Socratic pedagogy, liturgical or theological foundations, and a public-facing emphasis on traditional liberal arts canon—are not consistently foregrounded in public materials. The school does articulate a strong, serviceable pedagogy and a community-centric ethos, but its public materials show significant emphasis on individual learning needs, therapies, and college/career preparation, rather than a wholesale embrace of classical pedagogy.

Overall classification (based on the six-category rubric and the accompanying keyword framework): **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**.

- Why this matters: Element 5 (Faculty) and the presence of formation-oriented language tilt toward classical sensibilities, but Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations), Element 3 (Curriculum) cross-cut with a heavy project-based emphasis, and Element 4 (Pedagogy) reveal notable deviations from a full classical model. The aggregate pattern yields a profile that is leaning toward classical ideals in some respects but not fully, consistently classical across all six areas.
- Most consequential insights:
- Strengths: Faculty as living curriculum; strong emphasis on formation, social skills, and a nurturing teaching culture; high degree of family/community engagement; small classes and individualized support.
- Gaps: Absence of explicit Great Books or canonical liberal arts framing; limited public articulation of Socratic/seminar pedagogy; explicit religious/metaphysical foundations and liturgical/community practices are not evident in core materials.
- Needle-moving opportunities: explicit articulation of classical aims (telos, truth/good/beauty language), integration of Great Books or classical readings, and the adoption of explicit Socratic or scholé-inspired pedagogy in higher grades; enhanced parent formation activities aligned with classical education principles.

Citations and evidence drawn from Oak Hill Academy's public materials (school site content) and the classical lexicon are embedded within each category below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize a secular, inclusive, and whole-child approach rather than explicit religious or liturgical foundations. For example, the mission statements highlight education for students with learning differences and an emphasis on equity and inclusion rather than theology or liturgical practices.
- No explicit references to theology, liturgy, sacred music, or doctrinal catechesis appear in the main mission/vision content that is publicly highlighted.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: none from the Religious/Metaphysical Foundations lexicon (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty as transcendentals, theology, liturgy, chant).
- Negative keywords present: none explicitly (no signaling relativism or secularism as a stated stance; rather, the absence of explicit metaphysical/religious framing).
- Why this rating
- The school's public-facing materials do not foreground transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practices, or sacred rites, which are central to the Positive indicators for this category. The absence of these explicit religious/metaphysical commitments yields a NOT CLASSICAL designation for Element 1.
- Citations
- Mission & Services and Equity statements illustrating secular, inclusive framing rather than theology or liturgy.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes formation and a holistic development approach (academic, social, personal growth) and uses language around a “tiered curriculum” and “social skills.” This aligns with classical aims around formation and virtue, even if not codified with classical lexicon.
- Admissions and mission materials stress a focus on individualized growth, “nurturing academic, social and personal growth,” and a commitment to meeting student needs within a whole-child framework.
- Public statements reference equity, belonging, and a long-term developmental view for students with learning differences, reinforcing a formation-oriented telos rather than mere job-readiness.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: formation, nurturing, whole-child, character, social and personal growth.
- Values/terms in canon: “great conversation,” “truth/goodness/beauty” language from classical lexicon is not foregrounded, but the formation focus aligns with classical aims in spirit.
- Negative keyword analysis
- Present: explicit emphasis on college/career preparation in some program descriptions (high school focus) which is a negative signal for this category under the classical rubric.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates formation-focused aims and a holistic approach, which resonates with classical goals of virtue and wisdom, but the explicit emphasis on college/career readiness and the lack of

a strong canonical or classical-language framing push Element 2 toward the middle ground. The balance of formation-focused signals against explicit workforce-readiness signals justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

- Citations
- Positive formation-oriented statements (turn0file3, turn0file11).
- Mention of college/career readiness in high school context (turn0file5).
- What this category signals about overall classical alignment
- The school values formation and virtue-inspired aims more than information transfer alone; yet the explicit preparation for college/career tempers the classical alignment in this area.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Elementary curriculum mentions grammar, handwriting, literature, reading, science, social studies/history, and multi-sensory approaches, indicating a structured curriculum with traditional liberal-arts touchpoints (grammar, literature, history).
- The site references social studies/history as part of daily instruction and expression of a curriculum that includes literature and writing, aligning with some traditional curricular strands.
- However, there is explicit emphasis on hands-on, project-based learning in several public materials, which is a negative indicator in this category per the classical lexicon.
- There is no explicit mention of Great Books or the full grammarian/logic/rhetoric progression, nor of classical languages (Latin/Greek) in the public-facing materials. The absence of Great Books and explicit canonical readings dampens the classical alignment in Curriculum.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: grammar, history, literature, writing, narratives (as seen in elementary day-in-life; social studies/history; literature/writing).
- Negative keyword analysis: project-based learning and a modern, hands-on emphasis (negative signal under Curriculum).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum includes some classical touchpoints (grammar, history, literature) but lacks explicit Great Books immersion and broader liberal arts canon. The strong project-based orientation is in tension with classical curricular ideals. Overall, this yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Element 3.
- Citations
- Evidence of grammar/history/literature in elementary curriculum.
- Project-based emphasis within mission/vision content.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site emphasizes hands-on, project-based learning; that approach is a direct negative signal in the classical pedagogy lexicon.
- There is no explicit evidence of Socratic seminars, canonical recitation, or the other hallmark classic pedagogical practices (e.g., scholé days, memory work, catechesis, liturgical calendar integration).

The materials instead emphasize individualized instruction, therapy integration, and project-based work.

- Some references to a “tiered curriculum” and social-skill emphasis suggest a modern, differentiated approach rather than a traditional classical pedagogy.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: None of the explicit classical pedagogy terms dominate (e.g., Socratic seminar, recitation, memory work, scholé). The public materials do include elements of memory-related practices in other contexts (e.g., “structure” of instruction) but not in the classical sense described in the lexicon. 0 targeted positive signals.
- Negative keyword analysis
- Present: Project-based learning dominance; experiential or student-directed constructivism signals, as described in the lexicon’s negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The pedagogy is modern and student-centered with a focus on remediation, therapies, and project-based work rather than classical pedagogical methods (Socratic dialogue, memory and recitation, etc.). The absence of canonical pedagogical methods places Element 4 squarely in NOT CLASSICAL.
- Citations
- Evidence of project-based learning emphasis.
- Absence of explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy (no direct quotes, but absence is notable in the public materials).

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Head of School emphasizes a team of talented, nurturing staff who differentiate instruction and maintain a living, tiered curriculum focused on social-emotional competencies. This aligns with the classical conception of the faculty as the living curriculum and mentors who shape student virtue and character.
- The school’s public materials repeatedly describe the faculty as mentors, guides, and a core of the school (e.g., Executive Director, Director of Therapy & Tutoring, Head of High School, etc.), with explicit emphasis on collaboration, mentorship, and individualized support. This mirrors the classical portrait of teachers as virtuous exemplars and living models.
- The equity-focused statements and parent-community engagement further position faculty as central to a shared mission and living curriculum.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: tutors/mentors/masters/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; collegial culture; moral exemplars; character formation; teachers as core. The Head of School materials explicitly reference “the living curriculum” and “tiered curriculum with an emphasis on social skills.”
- Negative keyword analysis
- None clearly present in the public materials for this category; no signals indicating a purely “facilitator on the sidelines” or purely certification-driven model. The content instead emphasizes teacher excellence and mentorship.
- Why this rating

- The explicit emphasis on a high-quality, mentorship-oriented faculty who serve as the core of the school—paired with a living curriculum approach—aligns closely with classical expectations for faculty. Element 5 thus earns CLASSICAL.
- Citations
- Head of School statements on faculty as living curriculum and mentoring tone.
- Additional faculty/leadership context in mission and admissions content.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes partnerships with parents and family involvement, including a commitment to equity and belonging; there are explicit statements about parent input and collaboration as part of the learning community.
- Public materials show parent testimonials and a culture that invites parent involvement, with open admissions processes and opportunities to tour, observe, and engage with the school. The “Admissions Process” notes virtual or in-person engagement with families and parent inclusion in the process.
- Community engagement is further evidenced by fundraising and community events (North Texas Giving Day) and the school’s outreach to families across many zip codes.
- Positive keyword analysis
- Present: partnership with parents, co-teachers (implied by “family involvement” and “equity/ belonging” statements), open campus, parent formation (through information sharing and engagement opportunities).
- Other elements (e.g., classical parent formation programs, classical book clubs, liturgical family practices) are not strongly evident in the public materials.
- Negative keyword analysis
- Not overtly present; the school’s community narrative centers on partnership rather than a consumer/customer dynamic, but there is limited explicit evidence of a formalized “parent formation” program in the classical sense.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates meaningful parent and community engagement and partnership, which aligns with classical expectations for active parent involvement, but the absence of explicit classical-parent formation structures or canonical “family liturgy” style programs places Element 6 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Citations
- Partnership language and equity/family engagement in mission content.
- Admissions process and parent involvement in campus experiences.
- Community engagement and fundraising (North Texas Giving Day).

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal):
- Strengthen explicit classical telos language in public-facing materials (e.g., clearly articulate a classical mission that centers on truth, goodness, beauty and human flourishing).

- De-emphasize workforce-readiness language in core mission statements; elevate formation and liberal-arts aims.
 - Introduce a stated commitment to Great Books or canonical texts as a core component of at least certain grade levels, with a public-facing rationale.
 - Element 3 (Curriculum):
 - Introduce explicit Great Books/primary-sources components and a more overt liberal-arts framing (grammar, logic, rhetoric) within core curriculum descriptions.
 - Add a publicly stated history of Western civilization or classical-era history as foundational content across grades (beyond social studies history).
 - Minimize or balance project-based learning with classical pedagogical practices (recitation, narration, memory work, and occasional Socratic-style inquiry) to align more clearly with a classical approach.
 - Element 6 (Parents & Community):
 - Formalize parent formation and classical book clubs and lay out a structured “parents as co-teachers” program with measurable activities (reading groups, family liturgies, study guides) that connect with classical aims.
 - Expand family-centered offerings into a formal, public-facing pathway that mirrors the school’s classical mission (e.g., family sessions on classical education philosophy, household liturgy alignment, or liturgical calendar events).
 - General needle-moving items:
 - More explicit articulation of religious/metaphysical foundations if the school intends to align with a classical framework whose core signals include transcendental truth, virtue, and beauty.
 - Publicly publish a pedagogical plan that includes elements of scholé, contemplation, and structured rhetoric (with grade-appropriate examples).
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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